

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

AI-Assisted Product Descriptions

Vendor Onboarding · Swiggy

*Reducing onboarding drop-off by replacing manual description writing
with selectable, generated descriptions.*

Status: Draft v1 · Owner: Product · Document type: Feature PRD

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1. Problem Statement

During vendor onboarding on Swiggy, merchants are required to manually write a product description for every catalog item that needs one — typically 15 to 30 items for the majority of vendors. This step is repetitive and time-consuming, and it appears to be a significant friction point in the onboarding funnel: vendors raise support tickets about the description-writing experience, and vendors with larger catalogs are believed to drop off before completing onboarding or take substantially longer to go live. Even when vendors push through, many submit low-effort one-line descriptions purely to clear the step, degrading the quality of the customer-facing catalog. The result is a hypothesized business cost on two fronts: lost merchants and delayed revenue activation from slower time-to-live, and weaker product discovery and conversion downstream from poor description quality.

FLAG — Ticket volume/ranking and the drop-off / time-to-live impact are not yet quantified. These are treated as assumptions to validate (see Open Point OP-1) before committing heavy engineering effort.

2. Pain Points

PP-1 — Blank-box paralysis: vendors don't know what to write.

When vendors reach the description field, they face an empty text box with no guidance, examples, or starting point. With nothing to anchor against, many stall — unsure what level of detail is expected or what “good” looks like. Source: vendor onboarding support tickets [ASSUMPTION — NEEDS VALIDATION: inferred from ticket themes; not yet quantified].

PP-2 — High repetitive typing burden across many items.

The task is not writing one description — it is writing 15 to 30 of them in a single onboarding session, often free-form and frequently on mobile. The sheer volume of manual typing makes the step feel disproportionately heavy relative to its perceived value. Source: catalog data — the majority of vendors carry 40+ items, with 15–30 requiring descriptions.

PP-3 — High time cost that stalls or breaks onboarding.

Because each description must be composed from scratch, the cumulative time to complete the step is significant. This manifests in two observable ways: vendors leave most description fields blank (visible in catalog-completion data), and vendors who do complete them take substantially longer to go live or abandon onboarding partway. Source: catalog-completion data (blank descriptions observed); time-to-live and drop-off [ASSUMPTION — NEEDS VALIDATION].

PP-4 — Quality collapse: throwaway one-liners.

Even when vendors fill the field, the friction pushes them to enter a minimal one-line description purely to clear the step. The result is a customer-facing catalog populated with weak, low-information descriptions that undermine product discovery and conversion. Source: observed catalog content (one-line descriptions).

3. User Stories

Broad, strategic stories describing what the vendor wants to achieve at a high level. These map to many granular requirements in Section 6.

Persona	High-Level Story	Sub Stories
New Vendor (large catalog, 40+ items)	As a vendor onboarding to Swiggy, I want to complete my product catalog quickly and with minimal manual effort, so that I can go live and start receiving orders without the description step slowing me down.	– As a vendor, I want help generating product descriptions so that I don't have to write each one from scratch. – As a vendor, I want to add descriptions to many items efficiently so that a large catalog doesn't take hours. – As a vendor, I want to know what a good description looks like so that I'm not stuck staring at a blank field.
New Vendor (first-time / less tech-comfortable)	As a first-time vendor, I want the onboarding process to guide me through product setup, so that I don't get stuck or abandon the process partway.	– As a vendor, I want clear guidance or examples at each step so that I always know what's expected. – As a vendor, I want to complete onboarding on my phone without heavy typing so that I can finish it wherever I am.
Vendor maintaining catalog quality	As a vendor, I want my product descriptions to be accurate and appealing to customers, so that my items convert well once I'm live.	– As a vendor, I want descriptions that represent my products well so that customers understand what they're ordering. – As a vendor, I want to review and edit any generated description so that I stay in control of how my products are presented.

4. Mental Model

How vendors think about the task today. Vendors see writing a product description as a marketing and sales task — the goal in their mind is to make the product sound appealing (“make my biryani sound good”), not to satisfy a Swiggy data field. The

barrier is not motivation — it is effort and confidence.
[ASSUMPTION — NEEDS VALIDATION: based on qualitative read of vendor sentiment, not validated research.]

What they compare it to. This is not a Swiggy-specific problem in the vendor's eyes — they face the same description-writing burden when onboarding to other platforms as well. A noticeably easier experience on Swiggy is therefore a potential differentiator, not just a fix. [ASSUMPTION — NEEDS VALIDATION.]

Their current workaround. Vendors today cope by copying and pasting descriptions from Google and adapting them. In their own words, the task is a lot of time spent filling descriptions and copying material from the web. This is critical: vendors already have a workflow, and it is generic, manual, and low-quality. The AI feature does not introduce a new behavior — it replaces an existing bad one. The bar to clear is “better than copy-pasting from Google,” which is low.

How they'd react to an AI-generated solution. Vendors are expected to feel relieved rather than threatened by Swiggy auto-writing descriptions, because it removes work they already dislike and currently outsource to Google. However, the relief is conditional on control: vendors want to be presented with multiple description options and choose the one that fits, rather than have a single description imposed on them. The mental model is “help me by giving me good choices,” not “do it for me and decide for me.” [ASSUMPTION — NEEDS VALIDATION: vendor reaction is anticipated, not yet tested.]

DESIGN IMPLICATIONS — (1) Frame and design the feature as an upgrade to the existing copy-paste habit, not a new leap of faith. (2) Offer selectable options, never a single forced output.

5. Design Requirements

Written for designers. These describe observable user outcomes, not system behaviors. Once designs are signed off, each block informs one or more Functional Requirements in Section 6.

DR-1 — Generate descriptions instead of writing from scratch

User Story

As a vendor adding products during onboarding, I want Swiggy to generate a product description for me, so that I don't have to write it from scratch or copy-paste from Google.

Acceptance Criteria

A user is considered to have successfully used this feature when they can:

- Trigger description generation for a product from within the product-add screen.
- Generate a description using the product name they have entered (product name is the required input).
- See a clear visual indication that a description is being generated (loading / feedback state).
- Receive generated options within a few seconds (target: 5–8 seconds) rather than typing manually.
- Bypass generation entirely and type their own description manually if they prefer.

DR-2 — Choose from two description options

User Story

As a vendor, I want to be shown two description options to choose from, so that I stay in control of how my product is presented rather than having a single description forced on me.

Acceptance Criteria

A user is considered to have successfully used this feature when they can:

- See exactly two distinct description options for the same product.
- Clearly distinguish the two options from one another (meaningfully different, not near-duplicates).
- Select one option with a single, obvious action.
- See the selected option populate the product's description field immediately after selecting.
- Regenerate a fresh pair of options if neither fits, up to a maximum of 3 regenerations per product.
- Understand when they have reached the regeneration limit (the regenerate option is no longer available or clearly indicates the limit).

DR-3 — Review and edit before committing

User Story

As a vendor, I want to review and edit the generated description before it's saved, so that I keep final control over my product's representation.

Acceptance Criteria

A user is considered to have successfully used this feature when they can:

- See the full generated description before it is saved to the catalog.
- Edit the text of a selected description freely before saving.
- Save the edited version as the final description.

- Discard the generated options entirely and keep a manually typed description instead.

DR-4 — Per-product generation (v1 scope)

User Story

As a vendor, I want to generate a description for a specific product I choose, so that I can fill in descriptions one product at a time on my own terms.

Acceptance Criteria

A user is considered to have successfully used this feature when they can:

- Generate a description only for the individual product they are currently working on.
- Move to the next product and repeat the generation flow independently.

V1 SCOPE NOTE — Description generation is strictly per-product, on demand. Bulk generation (“generate for all items”) and a catalog-completion indicator are out of scope for v1 (see OP-8, OP-9).

6. Functional Requirements

Granular, implementation-level stories written independently of Section 3. Each maps to a single system behavior with testable Given/When/Then acceptance criteria.

FR-1 — Trigger description generation

User Story

As a vendor on the product-add screen, after I enter a product name, I want a way to request a generated description, so that I can start the assisted flow instead of typing manually.

Functional Requirement

The system must expose a “generate description” action on the product-add screen that becomes available once a valid product name has been entered, and must initiate description generation when the vendor invokes it.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a vendor is on the product-add screen and the product name field is empty.

WHEN the vendor views the description area.

THEN the generate-description action must be visible but disabled.

AND WHEN the vendor enters a product name that is at least 4 characters long and alphanumeric.

THEN the generate-description action must become enabled.

AND WHEN the vendor enters a name shorter than 4 characters, or one that is numbers-only or gibberish.

THEN the generate-description action must remain disabled.

AND WHEN the vendor invokes the enabled action.

THEN the system must initiate generation and display a loading state.

NOTE — Valid name = minimum 4 characters, alphanumeric permitted; numbers-only is rejected. Gibberish detection: a name is invalid if it is not a recognized dictionary term, does not follow standard orthographic / spelling patterns, and does not maintain an Index of Coincidence consistent with natural language — filtering both random strings (“asdasqwe”) and pronounceable-but-meaningless tokens. See OP-2 for the false-positive risk with regional dish names.

FR-2 — Return two style-differentiated description options

User Story

As a vendor who has requested generation, I want to receive two description options written in different styles, so that I can choose the angle that best fits my product.

Functional Requirement

On a successful generation request, the system must return exactly two distinct description options for the given product. The two options must differ by style (the pairing may vary by product category, e.g. ingredient-led vs. flavour-led for a dish). Each option must be approximately 10–20 words, focusing on key ingredients, texture, and cooking method, and must meaningfully reflect the entered product name.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN the vendor has invoked description generation for a product with a valid name.

WHEN generation completes successfully.

THEN the system must display exactly two description options.

AND THEN the two options must differ in style, with the style pairing appropriate to the product's category.

AND THEN each option must be between approximately 10 and 20 words.

AND THEN each option must focus on relevant attributes among key ingredients, texture, and cooking method.

AND THEN each option must meaningfully reflect the entered product name.

AND WHEN generation does not complete successfully (error or timeout).

THEN the system must show an error state and allow the vendor to retry or type manually.

NOTE — A failed / errored generation attempt does NOT count against the 3-regeneration cap. Style pairing by non-dish category (beverages, desserts, FMCG SKUs) is undefined — see OP-3.

FR-3 — Select an option to populate the description

User Story

As a vendor viewing two options, I want to select one, so that it becomes my product's description.

Functional Requirement

The system must allow the vendor to select one of the two presented options, and upon selection must populate the product's description field with the selected text, replacing any existing text without a warning.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN two description options are displayed for a product.

WHEN the vendor selects one option.

THEN the system must populate the product's description field with the selected option's text.

AND THEN the selected option must be visually indicated as chosen.

AND THEN the populated description must remain editable.

AND WHEN the description field already contained selected or vendor-typed text.

THEN the system must replace the existing text with the newly selected option without showing a warning.

FR-4 — Regenerate options (with cap)

User Story

As a vendor who doesn't like either option, I want to regenerate a fresh pair, so that I can get a better-fitting description.

Functional Requirement

The system must allow the vendor to regenerate a new pair of description options for a product, replacing the currently displayed pair, up to a maximum of 3 regenerations per product.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN two options are displayed and the vendor has performed fewer than 3 regenerations for this product.

WHEN the vendor invokes regenerate.

THEN the system must generate a new pair of options and replace the previously displayed pair entirely.

AND THEN the previously displayed options must no longer be retrievable on screen.

AND WHEN the vendor reaches the 3rd regeneration.

THEN the system must disable or hide the regenerate action and clearly indicate the regeneration limit has been reached.

AND WHEN the regeneration limit is reached.

THEN the vendor must still be able to select a displayed option or type a description manually.

NOTE — The regeneration count is fixed per product — it does NOT reset if the vendor edits or changes the product name after generations have been consumed. See OP-4 for the rename edge case.

FR-5 — Bypass generation and type manually

User Story

As a vendor who prefers to write my own description, I want to skip generation entirely and type manually, so that I'm never forced into the assisted flow.

Functional Requirement

The system must allow the vendor to enter a description manually in the description field at any point, independent of whether generation has been triggered.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a vendor is on the product-add screen.

WHEN the vendor types directly into the description field without invoking generation.

THEN the system must accept and retain the manually typed text as the product description.

AND WHEN the vendor has generated options displayed but begins typing manually instead.

THEN the system must accept the manual text.

AND THEN the generated options must remain visible and highlighted, so the vendor can still select an option if they change their mind.

FR-6 — Edit and save the final description

User Story

As a vendor, after selecting or generating a description, I want to edit it and save it, so that the final saved version reflects exactly what I want.

Functional Requirement

The system must allow the vendor to edit the contents of the description field after selection, and must persist the final field contents as the product's description on save.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a description (selected or manually typed) is present in the description field.

WHEN the vendor edits the text.

THEN the system must reflect the edits in the field in real time.

AND WHEN the vendor saves the product.

THEN the system must persist the exact current contents of the description field as the product description.

AND THEN the saved description must be associated with that specific product only.

FR-7 — Per-product isolation

User Story

As a vendor working through multiple products, I want each product's generation to be independent, so that descriptions and regeneration counts don't bleed across products.

Functional Requirement

The system must scope each generation flow — including options shown and regeneration count consumed — to the individual product being edited, held per product within the session.

Acceptance Criteria

GIVEN a vendor has generated and/or regenerated options for Product A.

WHEN the vendor navigates to Product B and invokes generation.

THEN Product B must start with a fresh, full regeneration allowance (3) independent of Product A.

AND THEN options generated for Product A must not appear for Product B.

AND WHEN the vendor returns to Product A.

THEN Product A must retain its previously generated options and its remaining regeneration count unchanged.

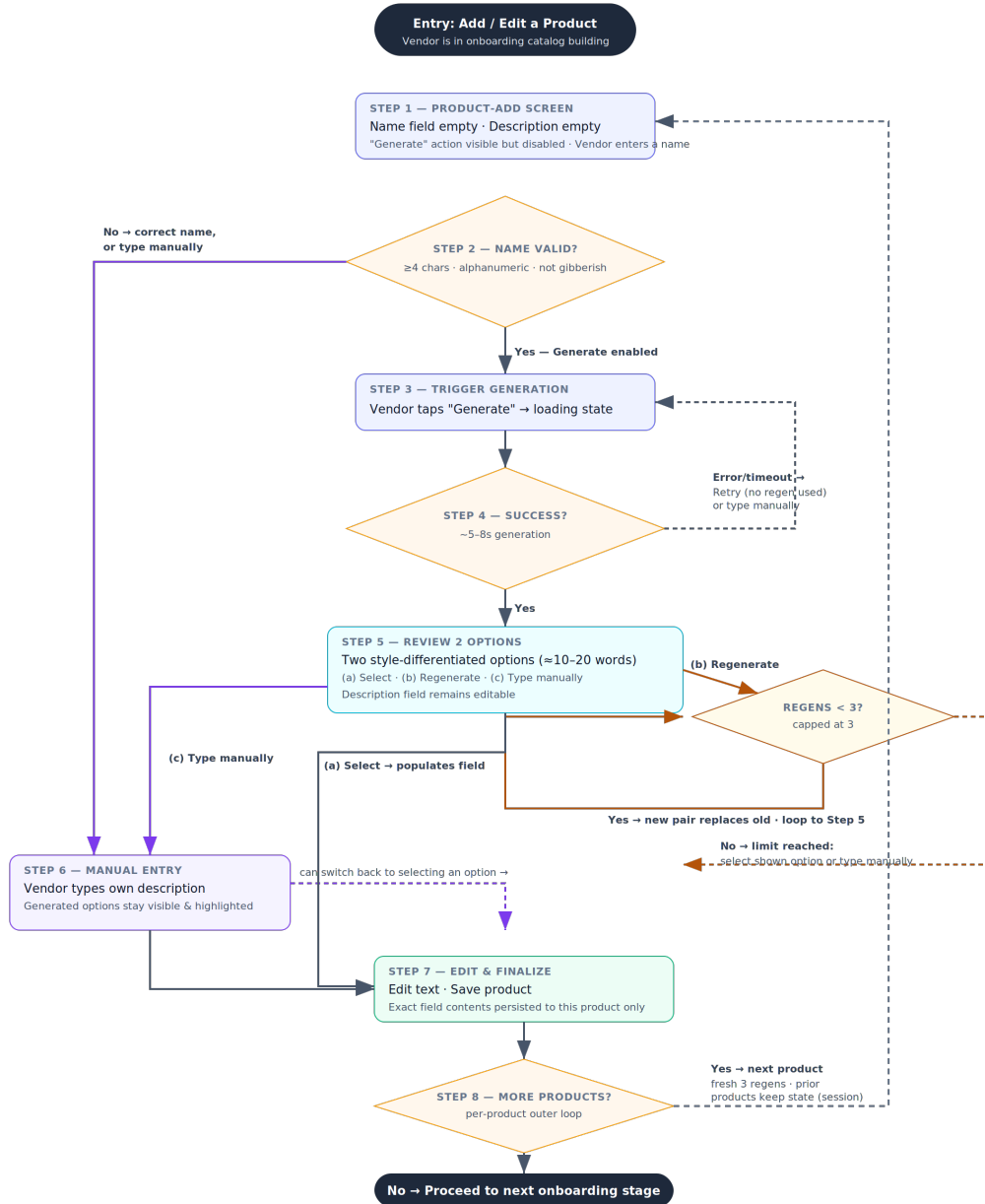
NOTE — Generation state is session-scoped: it persists while the vendor is in the onboarding session and is not retained across sessions in v1 (see OP-10).

7. Solution User Flow

The end-to-end journey, stitching the functional pieces into a single navigation flow. Decision points and loops are called out explicitly rather than flattened.

Solution User Flow — AI-Assisted Product Descriptions

Decision points shown as diamonds. Loops: capped regenerate (amber), manual/generated fork (purple), per-product outer loop (grey dashed).



Loops and decision points captured: the capped regenerate loop (Step 5 → Step 5, max 3, then forced exit to select-or-manual);

the manual ↔ generated fork (vendor can cross between typing and selecting until save); the per-product outer loop (Step 8 → Step 1, session-scoped state); and the error / retry branch at Step 4 (retry does not consume the regeneration cap).

8. Non-Functional Requirements

NFR-1 — Latency (generation response time)

Generated description options should be returned within an average of 5–8 seconds of the vendor triggering generation. This is a target average, not a hard ceiling. Any request exceeding the 12-second timeout must be treated as a failure and routed to the error state (Step 4), from which the vendor can retry or type manually.

NFR-2 — Availability & reliability

The description-generation service must maintain a 99.5% uptime target during vendor-onboarding hours, with a generation error / failure rate below 2% of requests.

[ASSUMPTION — NEEDS VALIDATION: confirm achievability with engineering / SRE for the chosen generation approach — see OP-5.]

NFR-3 — Scalability / concurrent load

The system must sustain peak concurrent description-generation load without degrading the NFR-1 latency target.

Vendor base (source of truth):

- Swiggy Food Delivery: 240,000+ restaurant partners across ~700 cities.
- Swiggy Instamart: 100+ cities, 600+ active dark stores; ~3,000–5,000 corporate FMCG brands, with localized distributor vendors in the thousands.
- Street-vendor onboarding (PM SVANidhi collaboration): fast-track onboarding of 36,000 street food vendors in phased targets.

Peak onboarding / update volumes:

- Festive surge (Diwali / Holi prep): 15,000–20,000+ restaurants and gift brands submitting active menu modifications or special SKU uploads concurrently across India.
- IPL season: 30,000+ localized restaurant vendors actively updating descriptions, retitling items to cricket-themed combos, or adjusting prices.
- New Instamart dark-store clusters: 150–300 regional FMCG distributor vendors onboarded in bulk per new geographic cluster to fill the initial 8,400+ SKU inventory requirement.
- Daily peak-hour content updates: 40,000+ active kitchens updating stock descriptions, marking items out of stock, or modifying pricing ahead of the 7:00 PM dinner rush.

CAPACITY NOTE — The figures above represent peak catalog-activity volumes and establish the upper bound of expected load. The specific concurrent description-generation threshold the system is provisioned against is a subset of these volumes (only sessions that actively invoke Generate) and must be confirmed during load testing — see OP-6.

NFR-4 — Error handling & graceful degradation

On generation failure or timeout, the system must fail gracefully — showing a clear error state and always preserving the vendor's ability to retry or type manually. Generation failure must never block onboarding completion. (Behavioral guarantee; enforced via FR-2 and FR-4.)

NFR-5 — Data handling & privacy

Product data sent for generation must be limited to what is necessary to produce a description (e.g., product name, category) — data minimization, with no vendor PII or pricing passed to the model unless required. Prompts and generated content are stored in-house on Swiggy-controlled infrastructure, with no third-party storage or processing. Retention: prompts and discarded / unselected generated options are purged once the vendor saves a final description for the product — only the saved description persists, as part of the catalog. Sign-off: a lightweight legal / security review is required before launch to confirm the in-house data-handling approach (see OP-7).

NFR-6 — Consistency of vendor experience

Generated options must consistently honor the defined content rules (≈ 10 – 20 words, style-differentiated, reflecting the product name) across requests. (Quality guarantee; tied to FR-2.)

9. Success Metrics

TARGETS NOTE — All targets are directional v1 commitments to be confirmed against measured baselines once pre-launch instrumentation is live. Items marked [BASELINE TBD] must come from telemetry, not estimation.

SM-1 — Onboarding completion rate (PRIMARY)

% of vendors who begin catalog / description setup and complete onboarding to go live.

- **Baseline (current):** ~ 55 – 60% overall completion. The remaining ~ 35 – 45% drop out or stall in the funnel due to documentation bottlenecks, of which the description step is a major contributor.
- **Target:** ~ 72 – 75% overall completion — a $+15$ – 17 percentage-point absolute lift, representing roughly a 25% relative reduction in onboarding churn.
- **Attribution note:** This is the funnel-level outcome the feature contributes to, not a claim that descriptions alone account for the full lift. Isolate the feature's impact on the affected segment ($20+$ items) via an A/B holdout.
- **Window:** 90 days post-launch.

SM-2 — Time to complete the description step (PRIMARY)

Measured as two distinct sub-metrics:

SM-2a — Active (in-session) time on the description / catalog step

- **Baseline:** median 45 – 60 minutes when attempted in a single session.
- **Target:** 40 – 50% reduction $\rightarrow$ median ~ 25 – 35 minutes for vendors who adopt Generate.

SM-2b — Wall-clock elapsed time from starting to submitting the catalog step

- **Baseline:** median 2–3 days (step rarely completed in one sitting; vendors stall, largely due to unorganized data).
- **Target:** reduce to ~1–1.5 days (roughly a 30–50% reduction).
- **Attribution note:** SM-2b is influenced by factors beyond this feature (vendor data readiness, other onboarding steps); treat as a contributing-impact metric, not a sole-cause metric.
- **Window (both):** 90 days post-launch.

SM-3 — Feature adoption (PRIMARY for v1 learning)

% of vendors who invoke Generate at least once, and % of saved descriptions that originate from a generated option.

- **Target:** $\geq 60\%$ of vendors with 20+ items invoke Generate at least once; $\geq 40\%$ of saved descriptions originate from a generated (or generated-then-edited) option, within 90 days.
- **Rationale:** Adoption is the leading indicator — the outcome metrics cannot move if vendors don't use the feature. Also feeds the NFR-3 concurrency model.

SM-4 — Description completeness & quality (SECONDARY)

% of catalog items carrying a meaningful description, where meaningful = ≥ 10 words (aligned with the FR-2 length rule).

- **Target:** $\geq 85\%$ of required-description items meet the ≥ 10 -word threshold post-launch, up from [BASELINE TBD].

SM-5 — Onboarding support-ticket reduction (SECONDARY / GUARDRAIL)

Volume of onboarding tickets citing description difficulty, pre- vs. post-launch.

- **Target:** $\geq 30\%$ reduction within 90 days. Marked secondary because the underlying ticket data was never quantified (Section 1 assumption).

MEASUREMENT METHOD (SM-1, SM-2) — Impact on the primary metrics will be measured via an A/B holdout — eligible vendors (20+ items) split into treatment (Generate available) and control (existing manual flow) — isolating the feature's contribution from concurrent funnel improvements. SM-3 is measured on the treatment group; SM-4 and SM-5 are tracked platform-wide pre / post launch.

10. Open Points

Validation & evidence (highest priority)

- **OP-1 — Quantify the core problem before committing engineering effort.** The Problem Statement and Pain Points rest partly on unvalidated assumptions (ticket volume / ranking; drop-off and time-to-live impact). Validate against real ticket and funnel data before build. (Sections 1, 2.)

Business rules & content

- **OP-2 — Gibberish-detection false positives.** The name-validation rule risks rejecting legitimate regional / transliterated dish names and brand names (e.g., “Misal,” “Thecha,” “Pav Bhaji”). Validate against a real sample of Indian vendor product names and measure false-rejection rate before launch. (FR-1.)
- **OP-3 — Style pairing by category.** The two-option style pairing (ingredient-led vs. flavour-led) for non-dish categories (beverages, desserts, FMCG / Instamart SKUs) is undefined. (FR-2.)
- **OP-4 — Rename-after-regeneration edge case.** Regeneration count is fixed per product even if the vendor renames it after consuming regenerations — displayed options may no longer match the new name with no regenerations left. Design should handle this gracefully. (FR-4.)

Non-functional / infrastructure

- **OP-5 — NFR-2 targets need engineering validation.** Confirm 99.5% uptime and <2% error-rate are achievable for the chosen generation approach. (NFR-2.)
- **OP-6 — NFR-3 concurrency threshold to be derived.** The actual concurrent-generation threshold to provision against must be modeled from SM-3 adoption data and confirmed at load testing. (NFR-3.)

Data, privacy & legal

- **OP-7 — Legal / security sign-off before launch.** A lightweight review of the in-house data-handling approach is required before launch. (NFR-5.)

Scope (parked for future phases)

- **OP-8 — Bulk generation.** “Generate descriptions for all items at once” is out of scope for v1 and parked. (DR-4.)
- **OP-9 — Catalog-completion indicator.** A “which products still lack a description” indicator is out of scope for v1 and parked. (DR-4.)
- **OP-10 — State persistence beyond session.** v1 state (retained options, regeneration count) is session-scoped only; cross-session persistence is a future consideration. (FR-7.)